Available online at www.sciencedirect.com

ScienceDirect

Lingua 263 (2021) 102810

Lingua

www.elsevier.com/locate/lingua

Fitting into a more appealing diaspora than my own: Positioning Ecuadorian and Honduran migrants within the Portuguese-centric diaspora community of Newark, New Jersey, U.S.A.

Anne Ambler Schluter

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University, Department of English, Hung Hom, Kowloon, Hong Kong

Received 31 August 2018; received in revised form 4 January 2020; accepted 9 January 2020
Available online 21 March 2020

Abstract

Set within the metropolitan area of Newark, New Jersey, U.S.A., this paper outlines a novel example of language and diasporic belonging by focusing on Ecuadorian and Honduran migrants who orient to the local Portuguese-centric diaspora, a group that reflects neither their ethnolinguistic heritage nor the regionally dominant culture. Communication Accommodation Theory (Giles, 1973, 2016), together with its power implications (Stell and Dragojevic, 2017), grounds this paper's investigation into the sociolinguistic characteristics of this orientation; the three primary components of investment – ideology, identity, and capital (Darvin and Norton, 2015; Norton, 2000) – serve as the lenses through which to account for this positionality. Analysis of interviews and observations through these theoretical frames provides evidence of horizontal assimilation (Prashad, 2001), the act of strongly affiliating with the culture of a non-dominant group that is different from one's own. These findings stretch the definition of diaspora beyond the dichotomies that have traditionally limited members' attachment to either the homeland or the receiving state (Grossman, 2019). By pointing to this space for Hispanophone Latinas within this Portuguese-centric diaspora community, these results illustrate the heterogeneity and agency that increasingly characterize diaspora groups (Deumert and Mabandla, 2013; Wei, 2018; Wei and Hua, 2013) albeit in a new way.
© 2020 Elsevier B.V. All rights reserved.

Keywords: Diaspora; Agency; Heterogeneity; Portuguese; Horizontal assimilation

1. Introduction

While a migrant group's continued orientation to the homeland represents a defining feature of diaspora in the majority of studies that seek to conceptualize this topic (Grossman, 2019), case-study research challenges this orientation by pointing to instances in which members of diaspora communities show deeper attachments to the state in which they reside (Gabriel, 2011). Individual diasporic experiences are similarly emphasized through the notion of *segmented assimilation* (Portes and Rumbaut, 2001), which draws attention to diverse orientations to the dominant/autochthonous group as a product of both individuals' characteristics and the specific nature of their reception by the host community. As various diaspora groups often live alongside each other within this context (Deumert and Mabandla, 2013), relationships between these groups also help to shape individual experiences. *Horizontal assimilation*, the act of orienting to a different

E-mail address: anne.schluter@polyu.edu.hk.

https://doi.org/10.1016/j.lingua.2020.102810
0024-3841/© 2020 Elsevier B.V. All rights reserved.

marginalized group (usually within the same community) instead of the dominant group or the heritage group (Prashad, 2001), represents a potential outcome of this contact. Applied to the sociolinguistic analysis of a setting that features diverse migrant groups, this notion informs a novel reconceptualization of diasporic belonging.

While the juxtaposition between the pull of the dominant language in the receiving community vs. the mother tongue/heritage language from the region of origin – echoing the contrast between Grossman (2019) and Gabriel (2011) discussed above – is well represented in the literature that foregrounds language (Cf. Kershen, 2000), a small number of studies move beyond this binary to highlight linguistic outcomes that more closely resemble horizontal assimilation. The appropriation of features and lexicon of less prestigious codes that are present in the community has received attention as a means of enhancing the authenticity of identification with the marginalized groups who speak these languages (Dirim and Auer, 2012; Magro, 2016; Nortier and Dorleijn, 2008); however, much of this research falls short of horizontal assimilation through their participants' very limited target-language repertoires (in the cases of Dirim and Auer, 2012; Magro, 2016) or focus on only one type of target-language feature (phonology in the case of Nortier and Dorleijn, 2008). An exhaustive search of the literature, in fact, points to only two studies that highlight one migrant group's more holistic linguistic orientation to another locally prominent migrant group. Both cases tie this orientation to the lingua franca of an employment context, highlighting the use of this language to facilitate access to a specific sector of the market (Vigouroux, 2013) and express solidarity with co-workers at the workplace (Goldstein, 1997). The current paper adds to this work by focusing on Honduran and Ecuadorian employees' accommodation (convergence) to the language practices of the Portuguese-centric cleaning company that employs them. At the same time, this paper also builds on this strand by expanding the scope of analysis beyond the workplace. Inquiry into the larger socio-ethnolinguistic setting in which the company is embedded underlines the pull of the Newark-area, Portuguese-centric diaspora community in terms of ideology, identity, and capital. This three-pronged focus accounts for participants' constructions of this other local diaspora as a more appealing alternative to their own diaspora communities; moreover, it guides their cultural and linguistic integration into this more desirable diaspora. These points of inquiry guide the study's renewed look at diasporic belonging that is grounded neither in the homeland nor the dominant culture of the receiving state but, rather, another prominent local diaspora community.

1.1. The setting: Portuguese-centricity embedded within an English-dominant region that also contains significant Hispanophone populations

An understanding of diasporic belonging among the three Hispanophone employees profiled in this paper draws on their positionality within different regional and local scales. Analysis begins inside the Portuguese-centric cleaning company (henceforth referred to as Shine) that employs one Honduran and three Ecuadorian workers as part of its Lusophone-dominant 18-member staff. It serves communities of Northeastern New Jersey, where English functions as the dominant language of the region and the households in which Shine employees work; this dominance is reflected most importantly through its associations with the bureaucratic mechanisms of the state – including visas, work permits, and citizenship – that bring stability to the migrant experience (Pujolar, 2015). In districts within this region, Spanish and Portuguese also function as important local community languages.

The center of the local Portuguese diaspora and home to many of Shine's employees, including three of Shine's four Hispanophone employees, is the Ironbound District of Newark, New Jersey. With close to 33% of the district's population claiming Portuguese ancestry,[1] the Ironbound has strong ties to Portugal that can be traced back up to three generations (Dos Santos, 2014). Moreover, the large number of ethnically Portuguese local business owners have built up the Portuguese-centric semiotic and linguistic landscape that lends a distinctly Portuguese flavor to the Ironbound District (Gonçalves, 2012). The long-time presence of Portuguese in this community has also recently attracted Brazilian migrants (Ramos-Zayas, 2012), whose culinary contributions have begun to influence the culture of the Ironbound. In addition to its Lusophone inhabitants, the Ironbound District also has a growing Hispanophone population from Mexico, Puerto Rico, Cuba, and a number of countries of South and Central America, including participants' native Ecuador and Honduras.[2]

[1] Based on demographic data about residents of the 07105 zip code, which covers the Ironbound District by http://zipatlas.com/us/nj/newark/zip-07105.htm#demographics (accessed 17.04.19).

[2] Due to the unspecific nature of census data, it is not possible to identify some of the Hispanophone Ironbound residents' countries of origin with any degree of certainty. As they are grouped together in the same category of ''Other Hispanic/Latino,'' this is the case for all non-Mexican, non-Cuban, and non-Puerto Rican residents who were born south of the U.S. border. This label is also problematic because it categorizes Lusophones from Brazil together with Hispanophones and speakers of other local languages from the rest of Latin America (excluding Mexican, Puerto Rican, and Cuban residents, for whom there are separate categories). According to the most recent census data, 35.24% of the population of the 07105 zip code in which the Ironbound is located identifies as ''Hispanic'', which is broken down as 1.5% Mexican, 6.84% Puerto Rican, 2.19% Cuban, and 24.71% ''Other Hispanic of Latino''. Presumably some Lusophone Brazilians and non-Spanish speaking residents from other Central and South American countries are also included in this category. (These statistics come from http://zipatlas.com/us/nj/newark/zip-07105.htm#demographics, accessed 17.04.19).

The high percentage of Ironbound residents with limited English-language proficiency,[3] coupled with the proximity of Spanish and Portuguese-language varieties to one another, result in a minor role for English as a means of communication and the emergence of linguistic hybridity to communicate with speakers across the Portuguese-Spanish divide. In these ways, the district's orientation is firmly grounded in Portuguese language and culture; however, its resident Brazilian and Hispanophone Latino populations help to create a local culture that partially reflects its diversity. In acknowledgment of these diverse influences, this paper will henceforth refer to this population as the Newark-area, Portuguese-centric diaspora community.

This diversity also reflects the demographics of areas within the larger city (Newark) and county (Essex County) in which the Ironbound is located; a look at Lusophone and Hispanophone populations according to these two scales shows a reversal of the Portuguese-dominant picture described above. Within Newark, census figures indicate that over four times more native Spanish-speaking residents (29.3% of the population) than native Portuguese-speaking residents (7% of the population) live in the city.[4] Moving to the larger scale of Essex County, the percentage of native Spanish-speaking residents (17.2%) and Portuguese-speaking residents (2.73%)[5] represents a smaller portion of the overall population while the proportion of native Spanish speakers accounts for over six times that of native Portuguese speakers. The resulting Hispanophone market accounts for the emergence of the Spanish-language linguistic landscape, which is far more visible than that of Portuguese outside of the Ironbound. In line with research on language contact and power relations (Cf. Matras, 2009; Matras and Sakel, 2007,), the relative power of Portuguese, Spanish, and English in the larger community manifests itself linguistically through the Ironbound's mixed variety of Portuguese, which features some lexical borrowing from English and Spanish in addition to morphological borrowing and semantic influence from Spanish.

The power structures from which this hybridity emerges also help to contextualize the choice of Shine's four Hispanophone employees to work at a Portuguese-centric company rather than one of the numerous options in the community that are English or Spanish-dominant. With its review of diaspora as it relates to language and identity, the following section adds a theoretical perspective to this context.

1.2. Diaspora, language, and belonging

Many studies that address language and migration have often used the term diaspora to refer to a range of different meanings, including as merely a synonym for migrant group (Canagarajah and Silberstein, 2012). This observation does not represent the entire picture, however, and some notable exceptions – outlined in the coming paragraphs – engage directly with the concept of diaspora as it relates to sociolinguistic positionality.

There is consensus in this body of work on the heterogeneous composition of diaspora groups as well as the resulting challenges to identifying their unifying characteristics. In line with this emphasis on heterogeneity, diverse language practices among diaspora group members reflect a variety of identities. At the same time, use of the shared migrant community language has indexical links to diasporic group belonging (Mills, 2005). Marginalization represents an intrinsic part of the diaspora experience (Gabriel, 2011); nevertheless, migrants' capacity to participate in the market on their own terms have increased in recent years (Sabaté i Dalmau, 2013), and this development has blurred the boundaries between the social categories of *migrant* vs. *local* in terms of socio-economic integration (Vigouroux, 2013: 243). The results have altered the ''social and economic affordances'' that frame individuals' ethnolinguistic orientations (Miller, 2016: 351) and help to account for diaspora members' increased agentive potential in recent sociolinguistic analyses (Canagarajah and Silberstein, 2012; Gabriel, 2011; Wei and Hua, 2013).

Moreover, the diasporic positionality itself holds ''creative potential'' to allow individuals to adapt and transform their identities to suit their new environments (Wei, 2018: 10; Wei and Hua, 2013: 44). As concepts of diaspora tend to neglect this adaptability, there is a need to conduct investigations into language and the diaspora that highlight this characteristic (Wei and Hua, 2013). Given the heightened contact between diaspora groups within the same community that is a feature of the current era (Deumert and Mabandla, 2013), this flexibility is increasingly negotiated between members of different diaspora groups; therefore, this research should also consider relationships between the prominent diaspora groups of specific, localized contexts. These aims guide the current paper, which uses data from interviews and observations to explore, through a sociolinguistic perspective, the diasporic belonging of Hispanophone Honduran and Ecuadorian employees of a Portuguese-centric multilingual cleaning company

[3] According to census data, 43.3% of the district's population reports speaking English ''not well'' or ''not at all.'' (http://www.city-data.com/neighborhood/North-Ironbound-Newark-NJ.html, accessed 27.06.16).

[4] According to data from http://zipatlas.com/us/nj/newark.htm#demographics (accessed on 18.04.19).

[5] According to data about non-English speakers in Essex County https://datausa.io/profile/geo/essex-county-nj/#demographics (accessed 19.04.19).

(henceforth referred to as Shine[6]) who are also embedded within the Newark-area, Portuguese-centric diaspora community outside of the workplace.

This paper begins by investigating language practice as a means through which to explore participants' orientations toward Portuguese-centricity within the context of Shine. Communication Accommodation Theory (Giles, 1973, 2016), which focuses on the linguistic adjustments that accompany speakers' alignment with (convergence) or distancing from (divergence) their interlocutors, represents the underlying theoretical framing of this analysis. Following this analysis, the paper widens its focus to examine the larger-scale structures and processes that contribute to the Hispanophone Latina participants' positionality within the Newark-area, Portuguese-centric diaspora community. As this type of positionality overlaps with that of a language learner who seeks integration into a target cultural group, the theoretical components of investment (Darvin and Norton, 2015; Norton, 2000) – ideology, identity, and capital – inform this analysis. Finally, a comparative look at the heterogeneous composition of the local Portuguese-centric diaspora community with respect to the findings from the diaspora work cited above contributes to a novel re-examination of the notion of diaspora as it relates to the community under investigation.

1.3. Research questions

The analysis that appears below weaves the above themes together with observation notes and the voices of Ecuadorian and Honduran employees, a Portuguese co-worker, and their Brazilian employer to address the following questions:

How does the Hispanophone participants' orientation to Portuguese centricity manifest itself sociolinguistically?

How does the example of Hispanophone employees' orientation to the Newark area, Portuguese-centric diaspora inform a reconceptualization of the notion of diaspora in terms of increased heterogeneity?

2. Methods, the cleaning company, and a brief cross-language comparison

2.1. Methods

The current paper draws on interviews from a larger study, conducted together with collaborator X,[7] which was guided by an ethnographic approach (Heller, 2008) and included three sources of data: document analysis, observations, and interviews. The language of the interviews varied according to the interviewees' preferences and, thus, contributed to a multilingual (Spanish, English, and Portuguese) corpus of approximately 300,000 words. A total of forty-one participants took part in the study, including Shine's owner (Magda[8]), her employees [$N = 17$], the staff's English-speaking acquaintances who serve as language brokers [$N = 4$], and some of its customers [$N = 19$]. Interviews with the employees and language brokers took place at the company's headquarters; interviews with the customers took place at their houses. Spending considerable time at company headquarters and the customers' houses during these interviews provided opportunities for rich, first-hand observations of these environments. More detailed information about these methods, including the researchers' positionality with respect to the company and its employees, can be found in Authors (2017). The data presented here provide detailed analysis of four employee interviews (each of which lasted between fifteen and thirty-one minutes). These data are supplemented by observation data from the Ironbound as well as content from interviews with Magda (Shine's owner) and Shine's customers. Moreover, interpretations of these data are also informed by knowledge of the content in the rest of the interviews, which have been triangulated against observations and document analysis carried out in collaboration with collaborator X.

The interviews highlighted in this paper address the following underlying topics that appear in the data analysis:

(1) The means through which Hispanophone and Lusophone employees of Shine communicate with one another (from both Lusophone and Hispanophone perspectives),
(2) Hispanophone employees' strategies for accommodation to Lusophone co-workers with limited Spanish language proficiency,
(3) Hispanophone employees' investment in Portuguese as an intertwined aspect of capital, identity, and ideology (Darvin and Norton, 2015),

[6] A pseudonym.
[7] The name of the collaborator will be provided during final revisions to help maintain the double-blind nature of this review process.
[8] This name, in addition to the names of Shine employees mentioned in this paper, is a pseudonym.

(4) The ideologies that guide Hispanophone employees' orientation to the Newark-area, Portuguese-centric diaspora community and, simultaneously, turn them away from their own diaspora.

The data collected through these interviews underwent both content analysis to identify emergent themes and discourse analysis to highlight Hispanophones' linguistic strategies for communicating with Portuguese speakers. Through this focus and approach, the analyzed data highlight connections between language choice, accommodation, capital, investment (Darvin and Norton, 2015), and diasporic belonging.

2.2. Shine and its employees

Shine was established in 1988 by a female Brazilian migrant named Magda who had a background in bank branch management as well as strong network ties to the local Portuguese community. Magda has served as the sole owner and chief operator of the business since its founding although two of her employees – both of whom are Portuguese – assist her with the administrative load by serving as assistant managers in addition to their house-cleaning duties. Shine serves 250 households and employs 18 full-time cleaners and one American driver. Shine's clientele is predominantly white, middle-upper class, Anglophone, and monolingual. In contrast, Shine's employees who work as housecleaners are Portuguese and Spanish-language dominant, which is reflected by their countries of origin: Portugal ($N = 10$), Brazil ($N = 4$), Ecuador ($N = 3$), and Honduras ($N = 1$). Although many of the employees have lived in the U.S. for considerable periods of time (ranging from 1 to 35 years), a large percentage of them consider their English language proficiency to be quite limited. Company-internal communication strongly orients toward a Lusophone center, which is a product of Magda's conscious management decisions when setting up the company (outlined in Authors, 2017). Magda specifically sought out married Portuguese woman in the local community whom – through her stereotypes of Portuguese women as hard-working, intolerant of disarray in their own homes, and compliant to their husbands' traditional expectations for their wives – she perceived as embodiments of ideal cleaning company employees. Such decisions have led to the hiring of a majority Portuguese staff and have fostered a company culture that, similar to the make-up of the Ironbound District of Newark in which most of the employees reside, has a deeply Portuguese core that is influenced by aspects of Brazilian language and culture in addition to offering a space for Hispanophone Latinos. Magda, who is highly proficient in English, Spanish, and Portuguese, facilitates communication between customers and employees as Shine's chief language broker. (See Authors, 2017 for a thorough account of Magda's language brokering activities at Shine and its influence on power dynamics.) As a result, English is not a requirement at the workplace, and Shine's staff demonstrate a wide spectrum of English-language abilities.

The Portuguese employees represent the majority at Shine; moreover, they are more likely than their Brazilian, Honduran, and Ecuadorian co-workers to have legal working status and, thus, greater stability. Because of this stability and their personification of Shine's Portuguese values that inspired Magda to create Shine (mentioned above), a core of the Portuguese staff consists of both the original and longest serving employees.[9] It is no surprise, therefore, that the average age of the Portuguese employees (47.5 years) is higher than that of the rest of Shine's staff (35.75 years). This difference becomes more pronounced when comparing Portuguese employees to Shine's four Hispanophone employees, whose average age is 27.75 years. Such differences in age and experience influence the nature of relationships between co-workers as will be discussed below with respect to the specific participants whose interview data feature in this paper.

Excerpts from interviews with four participants – one Portuguese (Dona Aura), one Honduran (Anita), and two Ecuadorian (Lila and Nina) employees – represent the focus of analysis. Dona Aura, an approximately fifty-five year-old Portuguese employee of Shine for nine years who has resided in the United States for thirteen years, is an established figure at Shine. Although she started working at Shine after its founding, she blends in with the founding core group through her age, Portuguese origins, and years of experience. Her co-workers' use of the address term 'dona' (misses) in front of her first name demonstrates her relatively senior status within the company. The three Hispanophone employees profiled have a relatively junior status within the company. Anita is a twenty-five year-old employee from Honduras who has been in the United States for six years and has been working at Shine for approximately four of these years. Lila, a twenty-six year-old employee from Ecuador who has been living in the U.S. for five years and working at Shine for approximately three, sends part of her salary as monthly remittances to support her young daughter, who resides in Ecuador. Like Lila, Nina is an Ecuadorian Shine employee of three years who has spent five years in the U.S. She is twenty-eight years old. Table 1 provides a summary of this information for each participant featured in the analysis.

[9] A fuller picture of Magda, her employees, and Shine's Portuguese-centric language policy appear in Authors (2017).

Table 1
Descriptive data about the four participants in this paper.

Name	Age	Country of origin	Time in the U.S.	Time at Shine
Dona Aura	Approx. 55	Portugal	13 years	9 years
Anita	25	Honduras	6 years	4 years
Lila	26	Ecuador	5 years	3 years
Nina	28	Ecuador	5 years	3 years

2.3. A brief comparison of Portuguese and Spanish phonology

Language contact takes different forms according to the different languages concerned. In the case of Spanish and Portuguese, which share a number of syntactic and lexical features, some degree of mutual intelligibility between many varieties allows Spanish and Portuguese speakers to communicate with one another – in limited contexts – through dual-linguality, the simultaneous use of two different languages (Piller, 2002; Vitale, 2011). In an effort to promote an understanding of these limits and the resulting mechanisms of accommodation that allow for communication between Shine's Hispanophone and Lusophone employees, a brief comparison between standard Spanish and Portuguese phonological systems is in order. As the participants profiled here did not tend to speak standard varieties of their mother tongue, this information serves as a rough guide to understanding the differences that potentially impede mutual intelligibility in spoken contexts.

As Spanish is a syllable-timed language, vowel lengthening and reduction processes are far less prominent than in Portuguese, a stress-timed language. For this reason, the vowels of Spanish words are apparent to Portuguese speakers, but the (reduced) vowels that occur in unstressed syllables of Portuguese words may be far less apparent to Spanish speakers who have no experience with Portuguese. European – in contrast to Brazilian – Portuguese varieties pose a greater challenge for Spanish speakers' comprehension because of their tendency for more extreme vowel reduction; the resulting syllables, which lack some clearly identifiable vowels, can mislead Spanish speakers to perceive consonant clusters that are not actually present. As the two languages contain numerous cognates, the written versions of the languages are largely comprehensible to readers of both languages with the exception of some differing lexical items. The spoken versions of these languages, however, bring out these phonological differences and contribute to unidirectional intelligibility to the untrained ear: Portuguese speakers with limited prior exposure to Spanish can often understand a large percentage of spoken Spanish, which features the vowels that their two written languages share. Spanish speakers with limited prior exposure to Portuguese, however, often struggle to understand much spoken Portuguese. These considerations help to inform the following discussion about the Hispanophone employees' strategies to adapt to Shine's Portuguese-centric language policy.

3. Results and Discussion

3.1. Fitting into Shine Linguistically

The following section draws on data from interviews with Dona Aura, Lila, and Anita to detail the mechanisms through which Lusophone and Hispanophone employees develop effective communication. These findings highlight the two Hispanophones' strategies for increasing their intelligibility as a means of accommodating their Portuguese co-workers. By focusing on the direction of accommodation in this context, this line of inquiry exposes the existing power asymmetries that ground the Hispanophone participants' orientation to Portuguese within Shine-related domains.

Interviews with Magda and her staff show a range of strategies for communication between Hispanophone and Lusophone employees, depending on the overlap of linguistic resources available to the specific pairing of interlocutors. Nevertheless, as reported in Authors (2017), many of Shine's Lusophone employees share the opinion that Spanish and Portuguese speakers, despite some of their multilingual repertoires, communicate primarily through *dual-linguality*, defined in Section 2.3 as the simultaneous use of individuals' different L1s as a result of mutual intelligibility (Piller, 2002; Vitale, 2011). Given the potential for one-sided communication challenges (highlighted in the phonological differences discussed in the previous section), this topic represented one of the foci of the interview questions and sensitized us to potentially divergent Hispanophone and Lusophone perspectives about Shine's internal language(s) of communication.

Dona Aura provides an established Lusophone employee's perspective on achieving mutual intelligibility with her Hispanophone co-workers (excerpt 1 below). Each employee differs according to her individual linguistic repertoire; Dona Aura is a noteworthy case because, despite her thirteen-year residence in the U.S., she remains largely reliant on Magda

to manage her English-language communication with customers and, further, has acquired a very limited Spanish-language lexicon. The excerpt begins with her describing the details of communication between Shine's Lusophone and Hispanophone employees.

Excerpt 1*

Dona Aura: 1. O espanhol entendo bem (Spanish, I understand well)
Author 1: 2. Entende bem? (You understand well?)
Dona Aura: 3. É, perfeito (Yes, perfectly)
Author 1: 4. Você muda- muda alguma coisa [para melhorar a comunicação?]
(Do you change- change anything [to improve communication])?
Dona Aura: 5. Um **poquito****, é (A little, yeah)
Author 1: 6. Como que você muda? (How do you change?)
Dona Aura: 7. As vezes a gente fala, erm, elas também entendem o nosso português (.)
(Sometimes we say, erm, they also understand our Portuguese.)
8. Elas entendem bem o nosso português e nós entendemos muito bem o
9. espanhol delas. (They understand our Portuguese well, and we understand their Spanish very well.)
10. é um espanhol muito fácil de aprender (It's a Spanish that's very easy to learn)
Collaborator: 11. Mas por exemplo, você pode dar um exemplo, que você talvez muda. . .uma
12. palavra? (But for example, can you give an example of something that you maybe change. . .a word?)
Collaborator: 13. Ou você usa mais o espanhol ou cê sempre fala o português?
(Or do you use more Spanish or do you always speak in Portuguese?)
Dona Aura: 14. Não, eu sempre falo o português (No, I always speak in Portuguese)
Collaborator: 15. Então nem uma palavra que fala. (So not even a word that you say. . .)
Dona Aura: 16. Não porque elas entendam o que eu digo pra elas e eu entendo o que elas
17. dizem pra mim (No because they understand what I say to them, and I understand what they say to me)
Collaborator: 18. elas mudam uma coisa (Do they change anything?)
Dona Aura: 19. Sim. . .Eu não necessito de mudar, porque elas entendem e eu entendo.
(Yes. . .I don't need to change because they understand and I understand.)

*Original in Portuguese
The Spanish-language diminutive (–ito) appears here instead of its Portuguese equivalent (-inho)

Dona Aura does not regard understanding Spanish as problematic. In fact, she claims to understand Spanish perfectly (line 3). Regarding conversations with her Hispanophone co-workers, she initially claims to modify the way she speaks (line 5), but she later confesses to speaking in Portuguese because her Hispanophone co-workers understand Portuguese and the Lusophone employees understand Spanish (lines 8 and 9). In line with employees' characterizations of Lusophone-Hispanophone communication practices highlighted in Authors (2017), therefore, Dona Aura points to the practice of easy dual-linguality to satisfy all employees' communicative needs. As Dona Aura continues, an analysis of her transcript brings the tools of accommodation into focus. In terms of her accommodation to Spanish-language norms, it is tempting to point to her use of the Spanish-language diminutive –ito (instead of its Portuguese equivalent -inho) on the word pouco (little) (line 5) as evidence; however, a familiarity with the local variety of Portuguese informs us that use of this form is merely in line with common practice among Newark area Lusophone residents.

In terms of Hispanophone employees' accommodation in the direction of Portuguese-language norms, Dona Aura makes some statements that, when looked at more closely, begin to suggest this type of accommodation work. With her reference to 'a Spanish that is easy to learn' (line 10), for example, she points to a special variety of Spanish that has been modified to facilitate Portuguese-speakers' understanding. Dona Aura communicates with her co-workers in Portuguese only (line 14) without making any such modifications to enhance its comprehensibility. Eventually, she confirms that if a co-worker has to undertake any accommodation work, it is the Spanish speaker who does so (line 19).

Such a nod to Hispanophone employees' accommodation efforts, together with the knowledge of Spanish speakers' potential comprehension challenges in this context, motivated a more comprehensive look into the communication between Hispanophone and Lusophone employees. For this information, Hispanophone employees' perspectives gain prominence. In our interviews with them, in fact, all four of them indicated some degree of convergence to Shine's

Portuguese-dominant center. While their comments should be interpreted with the caveat that they do not incorporate a situationally-constructed view of communication, they, nevertheless, are worthy of our attention as they provide a picture of Lusophone-Hispanophone communication at Shine that is more complex than easy dual-linguality.

Anita provides insight into a Hispanophone Honduran perspective on communication between co-workers at Shine. By describing returning home to her Hispanophone husband and mistakenly speaking Portuguese to him after a day at work, she captures the influence of Portuguese on the language practices of Shine's Hispanophone employees. Her example of Portuguese language use (in excerpt 2 below) suggests that she does not simply speak Spanish to her Lusophone co-workers (as the notion of dual-linguality suggests).

Excerpt 2*

Anita: 1. As veces estoy hablando en mi casa... y en vez de decir lunes digo segunda.
(Sometimes when I am speaking at home and instead of saying 'lunes' [Monday in Spanish], I say 'segunda' [Monday in Portuguese]).
2. Me confundo porque ya es como paso todo el día con ellas
(I get confused because it's like I spend the whole day with them)
3. trato con ellas entonces, ya el hablado ya se me va quedando a mi también.
(I work together with them so the way of speaking ends rubbing off on me too.)

*Original in Spanish

Anita reports using the Portuguese word 'segunda' to refer to Monday instead of its Spanish equivalent 'lunes' when addressing her Hispanophone husband in the Spanish-language domain of their home (line 1). This ''confusion'' (line 2) occurs as a result of the extensive time she spends working together with her Lusophone co-workers; furthermore, it suggests, at the very least, a Spanish speaker's active incorporation of Portuguese lexical items to facilitate communication with her Lusophone co-workers. In contrast to Dona Aura's description of the communicative practices between Hispanophone and Lusophone employees, Anita's comments provide an example of a speaker of Shine's minority language whose linguistic efforts to overcome language differences exceed those required for dual-linguality.

Dual-linguality – as described by Piller (2002) and put into practice by Dona Aura – envisions the two languages as equal; however, Anita's comments suggest a higher positioning of Portuguese over Spanish during these interactions. This positioning becomes more pronounced with a look at another Hispanophone employee's descriptions of her communication with Lusophone co-workers who, like Dona Aura, have developed minimal skills to communicate with non-Portuguese speakers. The following excerpt (3) comes from an interview with Lila, who borrows lexical items from Portuguese to facilitate effective communication with her Lusophone co-workers.

Excerpt 3*

Author: 1. Hablas en una manera diferente para dejarlas [las portugesas e brasileñas de
2. Shine] entenderte?
(Do you speak differently in order to allow them [the Portuguese and Brazilian employees at Shine] to understand you?)
Lila: 3. Sí (yes)
Author: 4. Como? ¿Puedes explicar un poquito? (How? Can you explain a bit?)
Lila: 5. Es como por ejemplo a veces ellas no entienden en español hablo en
6. portugués...
(It's like for example sometimes they don't understand in Spanish so I speak Portuguese.)
Collaborator: 7. **Então você fala português**?* (So you speak Portuguese?)
Lila: 8. Algunas palabras. Sí (Some words, yes)
Collaborator: 9. Algunas palabras **mas não tudo**? (some words but not everything?)
Lila: 10. **Não tudo** (not everything)
Collaborator: 11. **tá bem** (OK)
Lila: 12. **Mas** trato, cuando estoy con mi **namorado** trato de hablar portugués,
(But I try, when I'm with my boyfriend, I try to speak Portuguese)
13. El es-él es portugués entonces hablamos en casa.
(He is-he is Portuguese so we speak Portuguese at home.)

* Original in Spanish and Portuguese (Words that appear in bold are in Portuguese)

In excerpt 3 (above), Lila states that she changes the way she speaks when communicating with her Portuguese-speaking co-workers (lines 1–3). If they do not understand her Spanish, she inserts Portuguese words (lines 5 and 6), albeit with a limited Portuguese-language lexicon (lines 8–10) that she has consciously developed through conversations with her Portuguese boyfriend (lines 12 and 13). Together, the content of Anita's and Lila's comments show the important role that accommodation (convergence) can play in many of the Hispanophone–Lusophone interactions at Shine.

A closer analysis of excerpt 3 (above) provides further insight into the means through which Lila achieves this accommodation. As one of the interviewers is a Portuguese speaker with limited Spanish-language proficiency, Lila's interview transcript provides direct linguistic evidence of her approach to communicating with Portuguese speakers. It features both accurate responses to Portuguese-language interview questions (lines 7 and 9) and production of some Portuguese by repeating a Portuguese phrase and producing some novel Portuguese words (lines 12).

In an effort to achieve intelligibility with a Portuguese speaker, Lila chooses Spanish forms that are similar to their Portuguese equivalents, and she borrows words from Portuguese to substitute for words that are dissimilar. For example, ''algunas palabras [some words]'' (line 10) in Spanish closely resembles ''algumas palavras'' in Portuguese. In the same way, the Spanish-language phrase, ''quando estoy con mi namorado [when I am with my boyfriend (Portuguese-language word for boyfriend)]'' is very close to its Portuguese translation, ''quando estou com meu namorado'', with the exception of the word for boyfriend, *namorado*. The borrowed Portuguese word in this utterance, *namorado*, is the second part of her communication strategy in which she substitutes it for the Spanish lexical item, *novio*, because it is quite different from its Portuguese equivalent and can potentially lead to misunderstanding. Such a finding is in step with Anita's comments about using the Portuguese word, *segunda* (Monday), with her Hispanophone husband. As the Spanish word *lunes* (Monday) differs considerably from its Portuguese equivalent, *segunda*, its incorporation into conversations with Lusophone co-workers is most likely to contribute to communication breakdown. For this reason, the word, *segunda*, has become particularly salient to Anita, and she continues to use it even when she switches to Spanish-dominant domains.

These interpretations from the transcript are supported by comments made by a second Hispanophone employee from Ecuador, Nina, who specifically mentions in her interview that ''cosas que ellas [las hablantes de portugues] no entienden en espan~ol nosotros le decimos en portugués'' (Things that they [the Portuguese speakers] do not understand in Spanish, we say it in Portuguese.) She continues by clarifying that ''en el trato son mitad portugués e mitad espan~ol palabras'' (In practice, they are half Spanish and half Portuguese words.) Based on the transcript analysis in the preceding paragraph and Nina's description of her communication with her Portuguese-speaking co-workers here, a clearer picture of a communicative strategy emerges: when needed, Shine's Hispanophone employees can use a hybrid variety that incorporates key Portuguese lexical items while drawing on the Spanish-language phrasings that resemble Portuguese.

This strategic mixing suggests an ability to contrastively analyze the two languages, identify potential cross-linguistic challenges, and modify utterances to avoid some of these challenges. This strategy reflects Hispanophone employees' cross-language metalinguistic knowledge, which does not emerge in analysis of interviews with Lusophone co-workers like Dona Aura. This orientation to Portuguese suggests the inherent inequality of the two languages at Shine: while Portuguese speakers like Dona Aura may do little to accommodate to their Hispanophone co-workers, Hispanophone employees do not have this luxury.

Lila's, Nina's and Anita's efforts to accommodate the linguistic other on the one hand and Dona Aura's lack of accommodation on the other hand shed some light on language and power relations at Shine. As Dona Aura is a core member of the Shine community of practice (Lave and Wenger, 1991; Wenger, 1998) whose language background is in step with Shine's majority language, she possesses the linguistic capital that allows her to function exclusively in it. Her inability to identify Spanish speakers' efforts to accommodate to her suggests the normativity of European Portuguese (for Dona Aura) by accentuating Hispanophone employees' shortcomings relative to these norms rather than recognizing their distance from Spanish-language norms. This erasure of accommodation strategies from the dominant language perspective (like that of Dona Aura) demonstrates her relatively core position.

Moreover, these interlocutors' unequal attempts at convergence parallel findings about accommodation and inequality, which show that speakers of languages with less symbolic power are more likely to undertake the work of accommodation in the direction of speakers of the language with greater symbolic power (Bourhis, 1991; Stell and Dragojevic, 2017). Asymmetric attempts at convergence, thus, suggest underlying asymmetric power relations, and, through them, Lila's, Nina's, and Anita's orientation to Shine's Portuguese-language centricity. Power structures within communities of practice tend to reproduce those that exist within their larger scale settings (Contu and Willmott, 2003). This is also the case for the convergence practices at Shine, which are largely in line with those of the Newark-area, Portuguese-centric diaspora community. As common ideologies connect these two scales, the following section begins by addressing the ideologies that inform the positionality of the Hispanophone employees discussed here.

3.2. Orientations to Portuguese centricity beyond the Shine community of practice: a focus on ideology and identity

Section 3.1 highlights the language practices and power dynamics that reflect Lila's and Anita's positionalities with respect to Shine's Lusophone speakers. As positionality is grounded in larger-scale ideologies that inform identity (Darvin and Norton, 2015), the discussion now turns to the ideologies that come out of Shine's embeddedness within the Newark-area Portuguese-centric community. The extent to which membership in a new diaspora group suits these ideologies represents the second topic addressed here: identity.

Excerpt 4 (below) highlights the ideologies of Nina, one of Shine's Ecuadorian employees, about other Ecuadorian immigrants. She distinguishes this group from her Lusophone co-workers and friends, whom she views quite differently. Analysis of this excerpt helps to contextualize Nina's decision to work at Shine instead of one of the many Hispanophone Latino-managed cleaning companies in the area. In this way, it is possible to trace Nina's comments to ideologies beyond the Shine community of practice.

Excerpt 4*

Nina: 1. Tengo muchos amigos ecuatorianos, pero es es como qué si tú tienes más ellos
2. quieren tener y es como que te miran de lado. . .
(I have a lot of Ecuadoran friends but it's it's like if you have more they want to have it and it's like they are sizing you up. . .)
3. me gusta el trato de los portugueses e de los brasileiros. Tengo amistades brasileiras
4. que frecuento mucho.
(I like the way the Portuguese and the Brazilians treat people. I have Brazilian friends who I see a lot.)
5. es. . . soy así prefiero mi vida mi mundo aparte de la gente que me conoce.
(It's. . .I am like that I prefer my life my world separate from the people who know me.)

*Original in Spanish

In excerpt 4 (above), Nina describes her fellow Ecuadorians as jealous (lines 1 and 2) and insincere. She contrasts her negative evaluation of Ecuadorians with her Portuguese and Brazilian acquaintances, whose approach to relationships she characterizes in positive terms (line 3). While Nina has a lot of Ecuadorian friends (line 1), she chooses to spend her time primarily with her Lusophone friends (lines 3 and 4). In fact, she consciously distances herself from her own migrant community and expresses a desire to build a separate life from them (line 5).

Nina's comments provide insight into her negative ideologies toward Ecuadorians and positive ideologies toward Lusophones, which, together, inform her separation from the local Ecuadorian diaspora community and integration into the Newark-area, Portuguese-centric diaspora community. Moreover, these ideologies directly reflect those of Lila, who, in her interview, juxtaposes the ''self-centered'' and unhelpful character of Hispanophone Latinos with her ''more sociable'' and helpful Portuguese acquaintances (see Authors, 2017 for the more complete excerpt). In fact, similar connections also emerged during analysis of the data from the other two Hispanophone employees. Due to space limitations, this analysis can only be mentioned here briefly; however, it is clear that all four share an orientation to the Ironbound's Portuguese-centric community beyond the domains of Shine. Demographic data collected during the interviews, for example, point to all four of these employees' residence in Portuguese-dominant districts in either Newark or Elizabeth, New Jersey; moreover, each of them describes their neighborhoods as preferable alternatives to residence in Spanish or English-dominant districts. The development of strategies that contribute to successful daily communication within these Portuguese-dominant districts represents an outcome of these residential choices.

Analysis of these ideologies acknowledges their rootedness in the power structures that inform hegemonic forces (DeCosta, 2010). While the negative ideologies toward Ecuadorians and other Hispanophone Latinos highlighted above quite possibly reflect discrimination of these groups within larger power structures, investigation into this topic is beyond the scope of the current discussion. Of primary focus here are the positive ideologies toward the Newark-area, Portuguese-centric diaspora community and the social structures from which they stem. Embedded within these structures, these participants' positive ideologies guide them to construct professional and social lives that strengthen their Lusophone network ties while weakening those with members of their own diaspora communities. In this way, the data presented here provide evidence of an alternative diaspora group that generates positive ideologies that have typically been reserved for the dominant culture.

Ideologies such as these are considered a defining feature of ethnolinguistic identity construction (Darvin and Norton, 2015: 43), the topic to which the current discussion now turns. For the purposes of providing a more detailed example of this process, the case of Nina receives primary focus here.

Further data from Nina's interview transcript, together with comments from Magda's interview, suggest that Portuguese and the local Portuguese-centric culture feature prominently in Nina's social life. In addition to developing her Portuguese-language competence through her interactions with her Brazilian friends, her relationship with Magda – which stretches into non-work-related domains and includes social visits to Magda's sister's house – also provides ample opportunities. Under the tutelage of Magda and her sister, too, she has recently mastered a Brazilian culinary staple that has become a favorite of the Newark-area, Portuguese-centric diaspora community, cheese bread, which she now prepares regularly for her own family. Participation in such activities highlights Nina's affective attachment (Authors, 2020) to her Lusophone network, and she ''thanks God for bringing Magda into her life.'' In these ways, Nina's language and cultural acquisition efforts allow for ''the construction of the identities [she] desire[s] and the communities [she] wants to join in order to engage in communication and social life'' (Canagarajah, 2004: 117).

In step with her positive ideologies toward the local Portuguese-centric diaspora community, her active Brazilian social network, and her attempts at acquiring cultural knowledge, Nina's employment at Shine reflects a larger effort to become a member of a community that she views more favorably than her own. Nina adopts qualities that allow her to move closer to her *imagined identity* (Norton, 2013) as a member of a community of people who, in contrast to her descriptions of fellow Ecuadorians, she believes approach each other with sincerity. In Darvin and Norton's (2015) words, ''Whether it is because learners want to be part of a country or a peer group, to seek romance, or to achieve financial security, learners invest because there is something they want for themselves'' (p. 46). In this case, the greater *financial stability* that comes out of Nina's close relationship with her employer and the enhanced access to desirable *peer groups* like that of her Brazilian friends and Magda's family represent the benefits that come with her investment in Portuguese language and culture. Nina, thus, invests (Norton, 2000; Darvin and Norton, 2015) in these aspects because she perceives members of this group to be better aligned with her own identity. Although this investment does not extend to Nina's choice of romantic partner, Lila's comments from excerpt 3 provide an example in which investment in Portuguese language and culture also fulfills the romantic aspirations described above. Employment at Shine, with its Portuguese-centric orientation, thus, represents only one part of a more general positionality that ties together participants' identity and ideologies. The perceived benefits of this positionality, as the following section outlines, are rooted in the growing prominence of the Portuguese-centric diaspora within the local community that comes out of increased ownership of capital (Darvin and Norton, 2015). As a result, this diaspora can function as a viable alternative to the dominant Anglophone culture for those who, like the participants highlighted here, have the linguistic and cultural knowledge to access it.

3.3. Capital, neoliberalism and the local Portuguese-centric diaspora community

Long considered a strong motivator for potential language learners (Magro, 2016), the capital associated with the language of powerful groups and entities helps to shape diasporic trajectories (Deumert and Mabandla, 2013). Through individual migrants' increased tendency to ''follow the money'' in place of establishing ''close-knit, distinct'' ethnically homogenous diaspora communities (Deumert and Mabandla, 2013: 47), a direct link emerges between the shifting nature of diasporic positionality and capital. Moreover, the changes to labor and capital distribution under neoliberalism (Boas and Gans-Morse, 2009) – including the growing prominence of trans-national entities and commodification within political, social, and economic realms (Heller, 2011; Springer et al., 2016) – indicate a simultaneous shift in capital flows that can directly influence the status of diaspora groups. Such dynamics have created settings that diminish traditional attachments to the language(s) of the dominant community (Sabaté i Dalmau, 2013) and counteract the devaluation of migrant languages (conceptualized by Martín Rojo, 2013 and Moyer, 2018 as *decapitalization*). Indeed, given the underlying influence of capital on the systemic patterns of control that generate ideologies, which, in turn, inform positionality (Darvin and Norton, 2015), a direct link emerges between capital and the diasporic positionalities of the Hispanophone participants in the current study.

Bourdieu's (1986) three primary forms of capital – economic, social, and cultural – provide the theoretical foundation for the following analysis of capital as it relates to the Newark-area, Portuguese-centric diaspora community. Through discussion, it becomes possible to capture the pull of this diasporic community for this study's Hispanophone Latina participants with respect to capital.

3.3.1. Cultural capital

As mentioned in Section 1.1, much of the Ironbound District's semiotic landscape indexes Portuguese culture (Gonçalves, 2012). In addition, Portuguese business owners' common practice of using Portuguese cultural symbols to sell their products creates a marketplace in which the cultural capital of Portuguese often co-exists with its economic

capital. Some of these, such as prominent displays of the Portuguese national colors, are apparent to both members of the in-group and out-group; moreover, they bring profits from both of these types of members. In their interviews for this project, clients of Shine who lack ties to the Ironbound or its diaspora community characterize the Ironbound as a place that celebrates its Portuguese identity and is, thus, distinct from the rest of Newark, which they associate with a higher crime rate. The cultural capital that is tied to this Portuguese character comes into focus with these participants' primary reasons for visiting the Ironbound, which include eating at its Portuguese restaurants and buying Portuguese tiles. For in-group members, more subtle symbols help to tap into nostalgic attachments to the home country. These symbols, together with the use of Portuguese (linguistic capital) to serve customers, heighten the appeal of the given business and contribute to a loyal customer base. Magda, too, has created a business that builds on her own positive stereotypes about Portuguese women (Authors, 2017). These stereotypes shape her brand's image which she successfully markets to her clients. In this way, she has commodified (Cameron, 2000; Cavanaugh and Shankar, 2014; Heller, 2011) Shine's Portuguese identity to create her own niche market.

3.3.2. Social capital

Capital is embedded in networks (Sommer and Gamper, 2018; Uzzi, 1997; Wilson, 1998), and the use of these networks to recruit new employees demonstrates one salient means through which this capital can be identified. With respect to her recruitment method, Magda explains: ''Always they [her cleaning staff] are [her] source.'' Here, she refers to her practice of announcing job vacancies to her employees and tapping into their networks to identify eligible candidates. Although she placed ads in newspapers in previous years, she has since made a conscious decision to disseminate news of vacancies at Shine exclusively through word-of-mouth to avoid the challenges of sorting through over one hundred responses to these newspaper ads. This recruitment practice, thus, highlights the social capital of network membership. The reliance on acquaintances for news of employment opportunities underlines a direct connection between membership in the Newark-area Portuguese-centric network and the heightened prospects of earning a steady income. Employee recruitment through a local migrant network reflects common practice among migrant entrepreneurs (Kloosterman and Rath, 2001) and underlines the importance of such a positionality for migrants – relative to their non-migrant counterparts – who seek employment (Gamper, 2015). Within the setting of the current study, the social capital generated and converted through the ability to fit into a predominantly Portuguese-language network helps to demonstrate a way in which capital is intertwined with local and transnational networks (Bourdieu and Wacquant, 1992) that are detached from the dominant culture and the language(s) associated with it.

3.3.3. Economic capital

As the majority of businesses in the Ironbound District of Newark are owned by members of the local Portuguese diaspora and Portuguese is widely spoken within these spaces (Gonçalves, 2012), the economic capital of this community and its ties to Portuguese are on constant display in this section of the city. A business like Magda's, which operates an employee service van that runs between the Ironbound, company headquarters, and the houses it cleans, is deeply rooted in this Portuguese-centric community. Moreover, Magda's role as a language broker between customers and employees, coupled with her disdain for Anglophone workers who she believes ''don't want to work'' (Authors, 2017), creates a space in which Lusophone residents' cultural ties and language abilities afford them preferential treatment and can lead to a stable income. This income should not be underestimated given Shine's above industry-average wages and the relatively low turnover rate among Shine employees. With time, many employees manage to afford the purchase of a house and annual holidays in their countries of origin. The example of Shine, thus, represents one of many contexts in the Newark, New Jersey area in which Portuguese-language proficiency has the potential to enhance workers' economic capital.

3.3.4. Transcultural capital and the local Portuguese-centric diaspora community in the current era of neoliberalism

The three types of capital outlined above constitute some key origins of power in society (Bourdieu, 1986, 1991). With the shifting nature of capital flows under neoliberalism, new opportunities for more diverse participation in the market have emerged (Duchêne et al., 2013), increasing the potential for migrant businesses to improve their standing within the community (Sabaté i Dalmau, 2013). As trans-national networks generate and possess a larger portion of the capital within this context, they also hold more power (Cf. Portes et al., 2002) and have given rise to the growing influence of *transcultural capital* (Meinhof and Triandafyllidou, 2006) associated with prominent diaspora groups. Familiarity with the languages associated with these diaspora groups has, thus, increasingly become a source of linguistic capital (DeCosta, 2010).

Lusophone members of the Newark-area, Portuguese-centric diaspora community are in a position to exploit this transcultural capital most seamlessly: Portuguese-medium communication allows them to make use of their linguistic (cultural) capital, network ties that provide access to jobs represent an important means through which social capital is

used, and employment at a Portuguese-centric business helps to build members' economic capital. Those with different ethnolinguistic backgrounds who seek participation in this capital-rich network are able to do so by adapting to its linguistic and cultural orientation.

3.3.5. Putting it all together: capital, identity, ideology, agency, and diasporic belonging

This ability to shift orientations further parallels the dynamic nature of ideologies and identities (Darvin, 2016), which can adjust to suit the changing shape of power asymmetries that are largely driven by capital. The distinction between this vision of dynamism and that which is informed by the relatively static concept of reproduction (Bourdieu, 1977) highlights individuals' heightened agentive capacity. By carrying out the choice to orient to an alternative diaspora group, the participants profiled here provide an example of the interplay between individual action and socio-cultural structures (via ideologies) that characterize agency (Ahearn, 2001; Block, 2012). Specifically, they provide evidence to support conceptions of agency that recognize structure's influential – albeit not hegemonic – relationship to individuals' capacity to act (Ortner, 2006; Archer, 2000, 2007), especially in terms of orientations to foreign languages (Miller, 2016). This positionality gives rise to new conceptualizations of belonging (Warriner, 2007), including that of membership in a prominent diaspora group to which one lacks ethnolinguistic ties. Analysis of the shifting nature of structure largely accounts for the opening of this space, which represents a largely undocumented third alternative to the traditionally binary choice to identify either with the dominant culture of the receiving land or the heritage culture of the homeland.

4. Conclusion

The first research question addresses the sociolinguistic ways in which the Hispanophone participants' orientation to Portuguese centricity manifests itself. Despite the two languages' phonological characteristics that contribute to higher levels of Spanish-language intelligibility among Lusophones (relative to Portuguese-language intelligibility among Hispanophones), convergence efforts take place primarily in the direction of Portuguese and are largely invisible to the dominant group. Following Bourhis (1991) and Stell and Dragojevic (2017), these findings point to underlying inequalities. As communities of practice tend to reproduce the power asymmetries of their settings (Contu and Willmott, 2003), the positionality that informs this practice within Shine extends – through residential and social network choices – into non-employment domains within the Newark-based, Portuguese-centric diaspora community in which Shine is embedded. In line with Darvin and Norton (2015), this positionality lies at the intersection between positive ideologies toward the local Portuguese-centric diaspora community and participants' resulting construction of identities as members of this community; moreover, the benefits associated with these identities are rooted in this group's ownership of capital. The language practices of the Hispanophone employees profiled here point to participants' agentive re-conceptualization of their identities as members of the Newark-area, Portuguese-centric diaspora community. These findings reflect discussions in the literature about diaspora members' increased agentive potential in the current era (including Canagarajah and Silberstein, 2012; Gabriel, 2011; Wei, 2018; Wei and Hua, 2013).

The second research question investigates the example of Hispanophone employees' orientation to the Newark-area, Portuguese-centric diaspora community as a means of informing a reconceptualized understanding of diaspora in terms of increased heterogeneity. Given Ecuadorian and Honduran participants' identification with the Newark-area, Portuguese-centric diaspora community, the findings presented here provide an example of horizontal assimilation (Prashad, 2001) that stretches the implications of diasporic heterogeneity discussed in work such as Deumert and Mabandla (2013) and Wei and Hua (2013). Instead of pointing only to the linguistic diversity of diaspora members who trace their roots to a common homeland, the current study also finds heterogeneity with respect to diaspora group members' national heritage beyond the case of younger generations born in the receiving country, which has been mentioned in the literature. The resulting picture of a prominent diaspora community that incorporates individuals who were previously members of other diaspora groups informs the current study's re-envisioned concept of diaspora group membership. This access to a different diaspora group has the potential to influence diasporic belonging on the individual level: the findings presented here suggest that positionality is not limited to the two options of the local, dominant culture vs. that of the homeland, but, rather, the additional option of orienting to an ethnolinguistically different diaspora group also exists.

Data from this study help to ground some of the dynamics highlighted in the limited sociolinguistic work in this area. Situated interactions build a sense of community within diaspora groups (Canagarajah and Silberstein, 2012), and, thus, allow participation by those with the skills to interact effectively. Owing to their simultaneous presence in more than one cultural context, the Hispanophone participants profiled here possess the enhanced ''creative potential'' (Wei and Hua, 2013: 44; Wei, 2018: 10) to hone such skills, as demonstrated by their in situ adjustments to their linguistic resources as needed to suit specific Lusophone interlocutors. These findings provide evidence of the *linguistically constructed* nature of membership in a diaspora (Canagarajah and Silberstein, 2012: 84) that contrasts with definitions that focus on fixed

criteria, such as heritage or ethnicity. As a shared orientation to a migrant community language indexes diasporic group belonging (Mills, 2005), investment in this language and culture – through structural forces linked to ideology, identity, and capital – allows members of the Newark-area, Portuguese-centric diaspora to perceive the Hispanophone participants as part of their diasporic in-group. This positioning comes out of the increased contact between disparate groups that has accompanied the re-ordering of socio-political structures in the current era (Deumert and Mabandla, 2013) and is reflected by the diverse demographic make-up of the Ironbound. Similar to the ethnic composition of this district, there is space in this diaspora group for Hispanophone Latinos with Portuguese-centric orientations.

In line with the call to embed investigations into the notion of diaspora within specific contexts (Gabriel, 2011), it is important to point out that the current study's interpretations are limited to specific participants situated within a given diaspora community. Future research carried out in this setting has the potential to bring insight into the range of perspectives on diasporic belonging among others with similar positionalities. Such studies could also help to contextualize the magnitude and influence of the structures that bring value to the Portuguese-centric diaspora community highlighted here by comparing these dynamics with those of other area diaspora groups, including the Ecuadorian and Honduran diaspora groups that Nina, Anita, and Lila have rejected. These investigations will provide a fuller picture of the interaction between more diverse ownership of capital, the resulting growth of diaspora communities' influence, the ideologies that guide identity construction within these communities, and the potential for diaspora groups to include ethnolinguistically different members.

Uncited reference

Duchêne and Heller (2012).

References

Ahearn, L.M., 2001. Language and agency. Annu. Rev. Anthropol. 30, 109–137.

Archer, M.S., 2000. Being Human: The Problem of Agency. Cambridge University Press, Cambridge.

Archer, M.S., 2007. Making Our Way through the World: Human Reflexivity and Social Mobility. Cambridge University Press, Cambridge.

Block, D., 2012. Unpicking agency in sociolinguistic research with migrants. In: Gardner, S., Martin-Jones, M. (Eds.), Multilingualism, Discourse and Ethnography. Routledge Taylor and Francis Group, New York and London, pp. 47–60.

Boas, T., Gans-Morse, J., 2009. Neoliberalism: from new liberal philosophy to anti-liberal slogan. Stud. Comp. Int. Dev. 44 (2), 137–161.

Bourdieu, P., 1977. Outline of a Theory of Practice. Cambridge University Press, Cambridge, UK.

Bourdieu, P., 1986. The forms of capital. In: Richardson, J. (Ed.), Handbook of Theory and Research for the Sociology of Education. Greenwood Press, New York, NY, pp. 241–258.

Bourdieu, P., 1991. Language and Symbolic Power. Harvard University Press, Cambridge, MA.

Bourdieu, P., Wacquant, L.J.D., 1992. An Invitation to Reflexive Sociology. The University of Chicago Press, Chicago.

Bourhis, R.Y., 1991. Organizational communication and accommodation: toward some conceptual and empirical links. In: Giles, H., Coupland, J., Coupland, N. (Eds.), Contexts of Accommodation. Cambridge University Press, Cambridge, pp. 270–303.

Cameron, D., 2000. Styling the worker: gender and the commodification of language in the globalized service economy. J. Sociolinguist. 4 (3), 323–347.

Canagarajah, S., 2004. Subversive identities, pedagogical safe houses, and critical learning. In: Norton, B., Toohey, K. (Eds.), Critical Pedagogies and Language Learning. Cambridge University Press, Cambridge.

Canagarajah, S., Silberstein, S., 2012. Diaspora identities and language. J. Lang. Ident. Educ. 11 (2), 81–84.

Cavanaugh, J.R., Shankar, S., 2014. Producing authenticity in global capitalism: language, materiality, and value. Am. Anthropol. 116 (1), 51–64.

Contu, A., Willmott, H., 2003. Re-embedding situatedness: the importance of power relations in learning theory. Org. Sci. 14 (3), 283–296.

Darvin, R., 2016. The Routledge Handbook of Language and Identity. Routledge, New York & London.

Darvin, R., Norton, B., 2015. Identity and a model of investment in applied linguistics. Annu. Rev. Appl. Linguist. 35, 36–56.

DeCosta, P., 2010. Reconceptualizing language, language learning, and the adolescent immigrant language learner in the age of post-modern globalization. Lang. Linguist. Compass 4 (9), 769–781.

Deumert, A., Mabandla, N., 2013. ''Every day a new shop pops up'': South Africa's 'new' Chinese diaspora and the multilingual transformation of rural towns. English Today 113 (29), 44–52.

Dirim, I., Auer, P., 2012. Türkisch sprechen nicht nur die Türken (Not only Turks speak Turkish). In: Linguistik Impulse und Tendenzen 4. De Gruyter, Berlin.

Dos Santos, F., 2014. Os Portugueses em New Jersey (The Portuguese in New Jersey). LusoAmericano Publishing, Newark, NJ.

Duchêne, A., Heller, M. (Eds.), 2012. Language in Late Capitalism: Pride and Profit. Routledge, New York & London.

Duchêne, A., Moyer, M., Roberts, C., 2013. Introduction: recasting institutions and work in multilingual and transnational spaces. In: Duchêne, A., Moyer, M., Roberts, C. (Eds.), Language, Migration, and Social Inequalities: A Critical Sociolinguistic Perspective on Institutions and Work. Multilingual Matters, Bristol, U.K., pp. 1–21.

Gabriel, S.P., 2011. 'It ain't where you're from, it's where you're born': re-theorizing diaspora and homeland in postcolonial Malaysia. Inter-Asia Cult. Stud. 12 (3), 341–357.

Gamper, M., 2015. Bourdieus Konzept des Sozialkapitals und seine Bedeutung die Migrationsforschung (Bourdieu's concept of social capital and its meaning for migration research). In: Reuter, J., Mecheril, P. (Eds.), Schlusselwerke der Migrationsforschung. Pionierstudien und

Referenztheorien. (Key Works of Migration Research. Pioneering Studies and Referential Theories).Springer, Wiesbaden, Germany, pp. 343–360.
Giles, H., 1973. Accent mobility: a model and some data. Anthropol. Linguist. 15, 87–105.
Giles, H. (Ed.), 2016. Communication Accommodation Theory: Negotiating Personal and Social Identities across Contexts. Cambridge University Press, Cambridge.
Goldstein, T., 1997. Two Languages at Work: Bilingual Life on the Production Floor. Mouton de Gruyter, New York.
Gonçalves, K., 2012. The semiotic landscapes and the discourses of place within a Portuguese-speaking neighborhood. Interdisciplinary J. Portuguese Diaspora Stud. 1, 71–99.
Grossman, J., 2019. Toward a definition of diaspora. Ethn. Racial Stud. 42 (8), 1263–1282.
Heller, M., 2008. Doing ethnography. In: Wei, L., Moyer, M. (Eds.), Research Methods in Bilingualism and Multilingualism. Blackwell, Oxford, UK, pp. 249–262.
Heller, M., 2011. Paths to Post-Nationalism. Oxford University Press, Oxford, UK.
Kershen, A.J., 2000. Introduction. In: Kershen, A.J. (Ed.), Language, Labour, and Migration. Ashgate Publishing, Aldershot, U.K., pp. 1–8.
Kloosterman, R., Rath, J., 2001. Immigrant entrepreneurs in advanced economies: mixed embeddedness further explored. J. Ethn. Migr. Stud. 27 (2), 189–201.
Lave, J., Wenger, E., 1991. Situated Learning: Legitimate Peripheral Participation. Cambridge University Press, Cambridge.
Magro, J.L., 2016. Talking hip-hop: when stigmatized language varieties become prestige varieties. Linguist. Educ. 36, 16–26.
Martín Rojo, L., 2013. (De)capitalising students through linguistic practices. A comparative analysis of new educational programmes in a global era. In: Duchêne, A., Moyer, M., Roberts, C. (Eds.), Language, Migration, and Social Inequalities: A Critical Sociolinguistic Perspective on Institutions and Work. Multilingual Matters, Bristol, U.K., pp. 118–146.
Matras, Y., 2009. Language Contact. Cambridge University Press, Cambridge.
Matras, Y., Sakel, J., 2007. Grammatical Borrowing in Cross-Linguistic Perspective. Mouton de Gruyter, Berlin.
Meinhof, U.H., Triandafyllidou, A., 2006. Beyond the diaspora: transnational practices as transcultural capital. In: Meinhof, U.H., Triandafyllidou, A. (Eds.), Transcultural Europe. Palgrave Macmillan, London.
Miller, E.R., 2016. The ideology of learner agency and the neoliberal self. Int. J. Appl. Linguist. 26 (3), 348–365.
Mills, J., 2005. Connecting communities: identity, language, and diaspora. Int. J. Biling. Educ. Bilingualism 8 (4), 253–274.
Moyer, M., 2018. Editorial: language, mobility, and work. Lang. Intercult. Commun. 18 (4), 357–361 (special issue on Language, Mobility and Work).
Nortier, J., Dorleijn, M., 2008. A Moroccan accent in Dutch: a socio-cultural style restricted to the Moroccan community? Int. J. Bilingualism 12 (1–2), 125–143.
Norton, B., 2000. Identity and language learning: gender, ethnicity and educational change. Pearson, Essex, UK.
Norton, B., 2013. Identity and Language Learning: Extending the Conversation, 2nd ed. Multilingual Matters, Bristol, U.K..
Ortner, S., 2006. Anthropology and Social Theory: Culture, Power, and the Acting Subject. Duke University Press, Durham, N.C. and London.
Piller, I., 2002. Bilingual Couples Talk: The Discursive Construction of Hybridity. John Benjamins Publishing Company, Amsterdam.
Portes, A., Rumbaut, R.G., 2001. Legacies: The Story of the Immigrant Second Generation. University of California Press, Berkley.
Portes, A., Guarnizo, L.E., Haller, W.T., 2002. Transnational entrepreneurs: an alternative form of immigrant economic adaptation. Am. Sociol. Rev. 67 (2), 278–298.
Prashad, V., 2001. Everybody was Kung Fu Fighting: Afro-Asian Connections and the Myth of Cultural Purity. Beacon Press, Boston, MA.
Pujolar, J., 2015. Language, immigration, and the nation-state. In: Nancy Bonvillain (Eds.), The Routledge Handbook of Anthropology. Routledge, New York, pp. 301–316.
Ramos-Zayas, A.Y., 2012. Street Therapists: Race, Affect and Neoliberal Personhood in Latino Newark.. University of Chicago Press, Chicago.
Sabaté i Dalmau, M., 2013. Fighting exclusions from the margins: locutorios as sites of social agency and resistance for migrants. In: Duchêne, A., Moyer, M., Roberts, C. (Eds.), Language, Migration, and Social Inequalities: A Critical Sociolinguistic Perspective on Institutions and Work. Multilingual Matters, Bristol, U.K., pp. 248–271.
Sommer, E., Gamper, M., 2018. Transnational entrepreneurial activities: a qualitative network study of self-employed migrants from the former Soviet Union in Germany. Soc. Netw. 53, 136–147.
Springer, S., Birch, K., Macleavy, J. (Eds.), 2016. The Handbook of Neoliberalism. Routledge, London.
Stell, G., Dragojevic, M., 2017. Multilingual accommodation in Namibia: an examination of six ethnolinguistic groups' language in intra- and intergroup interactions. J. Lang. Soc. Psychol. 36 (2), 167–187.
Uzzi, B., 1997. Social structure and competition in interfirm networks: the paradox of embeddedness. Admin. Sci. Quart. 42 (1), 35–67.
Vigouroux, C.B., 2013. Informal economy and language practice in the context of migrations. In: Duchêne, A., Moyer, M., Roberts, C. (Eds.), Language, Migration, and Social Inequalities: A Critical Sociolinguistic Perspective on Institutions and Work. Multilingual Matters, Bristol, U.K., pp. 225–247.
Vitale, A., 2011. Linguistic attitudes and use of mother tongue among Spanish speakers in Japan. Japan J. Multilingualism Multicult. 17 (1), 30–45.
Warriner, D.S., 2007. Transnational literacies: immigration, language learning and identity. Linguist. Educ. 18 (3), 201–214.
Wei, L., 2018. Community languages in late modernity. In: Tollefson, J.W., Pérez-Milans, M. (Eds.), The Oxford Handbook of Language Policy and Planning. Oxford University Press, Oxford, UK, pp. 591–609.
Wei, L., Hua, Z., 2013. Diaspora: Multilingual and intercultural communication across time and space. AILA Review 26, 42–56.
Wenger, E., 1998. Communities of Practice: Learning, Meaning, and Identity. Cambridge University Press, Cambridge.
Wilson, T.D., 1998. Weak ties, strong ties: network principles in Mexican migration. Human Org. 57 (4), 394–403.